

# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 42051.06 ▼ 89.37 0.21% NASDAQ 19146.81 ▲ 0.7% STOXX 600 543.88 ▼ 0.2% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 8/32, yield 4.529% OIL \$63.15 ▼ \$0.52 GOLD \$3,181.40 ▼ \$58.90 EURO \$1.1174 YEN 146.75

## What's News

### Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Justice Department** is investigating UnitedHealth Group for possible criminal Medicare fraud, a probe that has been active since at least last summer. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks ended** mixed and bond yields continued their recent climb. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq rose 0.1% and 0.7%, respectively, while the Dow fell 0.2% and the yield on the 10-year Treasury note rose to 4.529%. **B11**
- ◆ **Cisco raised its** sales outlook after posting higher-than-expected profit and sales for its fiscal third quarter, fueled by continued demand for the company's technologies. **B1**
- ◆ **Sony, which makes** some of its PlayStation consoles and other electronics in China, said tariffs are likely to diminish this year's profit. **B1**
- ◆ **Dick's Sporting Goods** is nearing a deal to buy Foot Locker for roughly \$2.3 billion, a nearly 90% premium to the target's current valuation. **B1**
- ◆ **Tencent's quarterly revenue** growth accelerated as its gaming business remained strong and higher spending on AI began to pay off. **B4**
- ◆ **Bill Ackman resigned** from the board of Universal Music after his investment company reduced its stake in the label to just over 4.7% in March. **B3**
- ◆ **Empower said it will start** allowing private credit, equity and real estate in some of the 401(k) accounts it administers later this year. **B1**
- ◆ **Databricks agreed to acquire** database startup Neon in a deal valued at about \$1 billion, aiming to attract clients that want to create their own AI bots. **B4**

### World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump met Syria's** new president in Riyadh after announcing that he would lift crippling economic sanctions on the war-torn country and signing a number of Saudi investment deals on the first day of his Middle East tour. **A6**
- ◆ **Israeli airstrikes in** northern and southern Gaza killed at least 70 people, including nearly two dozen children, local hospitals and health officials said. **A6**
- ◆ **A judge ordered the** government to release from custody a Georgetown University academic and foreign national, Badar Khan Suri, who was arrested in March. **A3**
- ◆ **The FBI arrested a** former member of the Michigan Army National Guard who prosecutors said was inspired by Islamic State to plan a mass shooting at a base outside Detroit. **A3**
- ◆ **White House and agency** officials are resisting a bid by the health secretary to label pesticides as potential health hazards, fearing the stigma might disrupt the food-supply chain. **A1, A2**
- ◆ **Mike Johnson is** grappling with distrust from some members of his Republican party as the House speaker sprints to pass a tax-and-funding bill. **A4**
- ◆ **Tax-cut extensions** in the proposed legislation would help some households more than others, while Medicaid and other cuts disadvantage lower-income earners. **A4**
- ◆ **The number of people** who died of drug overdoses in the U.S. fell dramatically in 2024, fueled largely by a decline in deaths tied to synthetic opioids. **A2**

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Warren Buffett is stepping back at the behemoth he built, which owns insurers, railroads, utilities and household brands.

## Buffett Finally Felt His Age

Investor opens up to Journal: 'How do you know the day that you become old?'

By KAREN LANGLEY

Warren Buffett can't put his finger on exactly when he decided to hand over the reins of Berkshire Hathaway to Greg Abel. But in recent years Buffett observed just how much energy his appointed successor brought to each working day. And how his own days had slowed. The two men were operating at different

speeds—increasingly so.

"There was no magic moment," Buffett, now 94 years old, said in an interview with The Wall Street Journal. "How do you know the day that you become old?"

Berkshire shareholders and onlookers have long wondered how anyone could replace Buffett, for decades a towering figure in American business and finance. But as he passed his 90th birthday,

Buffett began to experience something most people come to accept much earlier in life: his age.

"I didn't really start getting old, for some strange reason, until I was about 90," he said by phone from his office in Omaha, Neb. "But when you start getting old, it does become—it's irreversible."

He began to lose his balance, occasionally, and sometimes had trouble recalling a

person's name. Suddenly, the newspapers he read looked like they were printed with too little ink.

In the past year, those thoughts and feelings cohered into a decision. On May 3, at the Berkshire annual meeting, Buffett stunned the investing world when he revealed in the final minutes of his question-and-answer session his plan to

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## Kennedy, Other U.S. Officials Clash Over Pesticides

WASHINGTON—A bid by Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. to label pesticides as a potential cause of U.S. health woes has attracted pushback from some White House and agency officials who are concerned the move would disrupt the food-supply chain, according to people familiar with the debate.

By Kristina Peterson, Josh Dawsey and Liz Essley Whyte

Kennedy, who is spearheading a coming report to "Make America Healthy Again," wants to highlight what he views as the deleterious impact of pesticides, people familiar with the matter said. He previously campaigned on removing pesticides from the food supply.

White House officials have raised concerns about the pesticide push and are closely reviewing the coming report, the people said, though it wasn't clear where President Trump himself stood on the issue. And some officials at the Environmental Protection Agency, which regulates pesticides, and Agriculture Department have cast doubt on Kennedy's desire to cast weedkillers as harmful to health.

Trump pledged on the campaign trail to investigate pesticides as part of an effort to win support from Kennedy's backers. "Millions and millions of Americans who want clean

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◆ **Lawmakers grill** RFK Jr. over vaccines, worker cuts..... **A2**

## INSIDE



**PERSONAL JOURNAL**  
Well-paid job hoppers bemoan cooler market that makes it harder to keep salaries up. **A9**



**BUSINESS & FINANCE**  
The streaming platform once called HBO Max, then Max, is HBO Max again. **B1**

## Women Are Drinking More, And Doctors Are Worried

By BRIANNA ABBOTT

At bars and dinner tables across the U.S., women are throwing back more drinks—raising concerns about the health consequences of their alcohol consumption.

Women in their 30s and 40s have increased their alcohol consumption in recent decades, as their lifestyles have changed. Women who turned 35 between

2018 and 2019 were nearly 60% more likely to report recent binge-drinking or alcohol use disorder symptoms than women who turned 35 between 1993 and 1997, according to a 2023 report published in the journal *Addiction*.

Doctors are now witnessing more hospitalizations of women for liver disease, and some researchers suspect alcohol con-

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## Secret Purges, Tense Standoffs: The War Over Household Clutter

American homes are bursting with stuff, pushing couples to extremes; tossing socks

By DALVIN BROWN

Michael Royer has been secretly tossing his wife's socks into the trash for years. Not her everyday pairs, but the size-14 ones her mom orders as gifts from fast-fashion sites like Temu. He's done it nearly a dozen times, burying

them under garbage to avoid detection.

"She'll never wear them," said Royer, a 33-year-old food insecurity researcher living in San Jose, Calif. "And she never notices they're gone."

Royer asked that we not mention the socks to his wife, and said he

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*Act of war*

## The King of Davos Loses His Throne

World Economic Forum founder Schwab's fall came amid threats to board members

For decades, Klaus Schwab ruled over Davos like royalty. That reign ended when he hit "send" on

By Jenny Strasburg, Shalini Ramachandran, Suzanne Vranica and AnnaMaria Andriotis

an email to World Economic Forum trustees on a recent Friday afternoon. Schwab was seemingly

headed for a graceful exit from the organization he founded more than a half-century ago, after a 2024 investigation by The Wall Street Journal exposed evidence of a toxic culture at the Forum for women and Black employees. But by Friday, April 18, the trustees' audit committee recommended opening a probe into a new wave of whistle-

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